

DETAILED LESSON PLAN

Lesson 2: First encounter

55 minutes | 5e International Section | UK Year 8 equivalent

Learning intention
Read a complete short story for gist while tracking shifts in mood and expectation. Students preserve the journey of a first reading before moving into close analysis.

Component	Lesson decision
Core text	Ray Bradbury, All Summer in a Day (full text supplied separately through the existing 10 Short Stories resource).
Evidence	An accurate six-event plot line, three selected mood/expectation shifts, a one-sentence gist and an initial reaction.
Prior learning	SPARK elements and the shared annotation code from Lesson 1.
Next lesson	Explicit, implicit and inferred meaning: turning first impressions into evidence-based conclusions.

Pronote agenda summary

For parents
Students read Ray Bradbury's All Summer in a Day for the first time. They track changes in mood and expectation without over-annotating, then work in pairs to reduce the plot to six essential events and write a precise one-sentence gist.

Curriculum alignment

KS3 Reading: understand increasingly challenging fiction; make inferences and refer to evidence; know how setting, plot and characterisation shape meaning; discuss reading with precision. KS3 Writing: summarise and organise ideas concisely for a clear reader.

Outcomes and preparation

By the end of the lesson, students should be able to:

- sustain a complete first reading without turning it into a device hunt
- identify three moments when mood or expectation shifts
- select six events that preserve the causal spine of the plot
- state the story's gist in one sentence
- record an honest initial reaction and begin to justify it

Success criteria

Secure	Developing	Exceeding
Six causal events in order; three plausible shifts linked to moments in the text; gist names the central pressure and consequence.	Timeline is broadly ordered but includes minor detail or misses a turning point; gist retells rather than distils.	Timeline choices reveal cause and consequence; gist captures the moral or emotional complexity without becoming a theme essay.

Materials

- Self-contained Lesson 2 IWB toolkit
- Printed or pre-downloaded copy of All Summer in a Day; do not rely on live internet
- Worksheet 1: First-read tracker
- Worksheet 2: Six-event story spine
- Pens; one optional highlighter only

Before students arrive

1. Pre-download or print the legally supplied story text.
2. Open the IWB toolkit locally and test the Story link, timer, blackout and Next prompt controls.
3. Put Worksheet 1 on desks; hold Worksheet 2 until the reading ends.
4. Keep the post-reading sunlight image and model timeline hidden.
5. Decide which students may use a quiet teacher read-aloud group.

Spoiler-light context

Teach now	Hold until after reading
Ray Bradbury wrote speculative fiction that uses imagined worlds to test human behaviour. This story is set on a fictional Venus where rain is almost constant and sunshine is exceptionally rare. It is literature, not a scientific account of Venus.	Do not reveal Margot's treatment, the confinement, the children's experience of sunlight, the return of rain or the final act.

Content awareness

The story includes sustained peer exclusion, bullying and brief confinement. Keep discussion focused on authorial choices and consequences; do not invite personal disclosures in public.

Minute-by-minute teaching sequence

Time	Teacher moves	Student actions	Evidence / check
0-5 Retrieval	Use the IWB rotating SPARK prompts. Students answer on mini-whiteboards or fingers/letters. Ask one student to explain why a detail fits the chosen element.	Retrieve Setting, Protagonist, Aim/problem, Rising pressure and Key change.	Four rapid responses plus one explanation. Repair confusion between a plot event and a key change.
5-13 Context	Display the rain-classroom image and title. Give the spoiler-light context in no more than 90 seconds. Ask: What might endless rain do to memory, mood and group behaviour? Keep all answers provisional.	Record one observation, one expectation and one reason. Pair-share with might / because.	Listen for evidence-led prediction rather than invented plot. Do not validate story-specific guesses.
13-40 First read	Give one instruction: read for the journey. On Worksheet 1, students may record only three shift moments. Start the 27-minute timer. Maintain silence; use optional checkpoint prompts only if the class needs refocusing.	Read the complete story. At three self-chosen moments, note mood or expectation before -> after and a brief trigger.	Circulate for reading stamina and comprehension. At minute 27, ask for a thumb check; support students who are behind without rushing the room.
40-50 Pair timeline	Reveal Worksheet 2 and the sunlight image. Set exactly six events, maximum ten words each. Partners mark the hinge event and justify one event they deliberately omitted.	Negotiate a six-event causal timeline. Select the hinge and explain an omission.	Check order, causation and significance. Challenge lists padded with setting detail. Reveal model only after comparison.
50-55 Gist + exit	Use the formula: protagonist/group + central pressure + key consequence. Students write independently, then add an initial reaction. Collect Worksheet 2.	Write one sentence, 30 words maximum. Circle a reaction and add because + one precise reason.	Read three gists quickly: accurate, concise, causal. Use results to group Lesson 3 support.

Teacher language and reading routine

Opening retrieval

Say
Last lesson, SPARK helped us see the compressed parts of short fiction. Today we will use that frame lightly. Our main job is to experience a complete story and notice when it changes what we feel or expect.

Context script: 90 seconds

Say
Ray Bradbury was a writer of speculative fiction: stories that ask 'what if?' in order to examine people. This story takes place on an imagined Venus where rain is almost constant and sunshine is extraordinarily rare. Bradbury's Venus is not a science lesson. As you read, notice what this invented environment does to memory, mood and group behaviour. I will not tell you anything else.

First-reading contract

Do	Avoid
Keep moving; tolerate a word you cannot immediately define; mark no more than three genuine shifts; use a short trigger rather than copying a quotation.	Hunting for every technique; highlighting whole paragraphs; stopping after every line; trying to guess what the teacher thinks.

Optional checkpoint prompts

These are for refocusing, not discussion. Display at most one at a time and do not pause the whole class if reading is flowing.

Checkpoint	Silent prompt
After the opening pages	Whose experience feels different from the group's?
Near the central turn	Place a single line: what did you expect immediately before this moment?
Near the ending	What has changed: the situation, the children, your judgement, or more than one?

Pacing response

If many students are unfinished at minute 40: protect comprehension. Give three additional minutes, reduce pair work to five events orally and retain the independent gist. If most finish early: students reread their three shift points and decide which is the true hinge; they do not begin a device hunt.

Post-reading model and likely thinking

Possible six-event story spine

#	Event	Function
1	Children wait for sunshine after seven years of rain.	Premise and anticipation
2	Margot remembers Earth's sun; classmates resent and doubt her.	Difference becomes conflict
3	The children lock Margot away before the sun appears.	Hinge: pressure becomes action
4	The rain stops and the children experience sunlight.	Release and wonder
5	Rain returns; their joy collapses.	Reversal and recognition
6	They remember Margot and silently release her.	Consequence; unresolved moral weight

Model gist

Reveal only after students write

On a rain-soaked imagined Venus, children jealous of Margot's memory of the sun exclude her from its brief return, recognising the cruelty of their choice only when it is too late.

Acceptable variation

Students may frame the story around Margot or the group. A strong gist must still identify the central pressure and consequence. Do not penalise a student for not naming every event, and do not require a theme word.

Anticipated misconceptions

Issue	Response
Every interesting moment becomes essential.	Ask: if this event disappears, does the cause-and-effect spine still make sense?
Mood and weather are treated as identical.	Weather can help create mood, but mood is the emotional atmosphere produced for the reader.
Expectation is written as hindsight.	Require before -> after language at the selected moment.
The gist becomes a moral lesson.	Return to what happens, to whom, under what pressure and with what consequence.
Reaction becomes unsupported judgement.	Add because and one story-specific reason; no quotation is required yet.

Differentiation, assessment and follow-up

Responsive support

Access	Core	Stretch
Provide the before -> after stems; allow a quiet teacher read-aloud group; permit a five-event oral rehearsal before completing six; pre-teach relentless, surged and slackening only if they block access.	Independent complete read; three shift entries; six-event timeline; one-sentence gist and reasoned reaction.	Name the hinge and defend why it matters more than another event; identify where the reader's judgement changes before the situation changes.

Evidence to collect

Evidence	What to notice	Lesson 3 response
Three shifts	Before/after thinking is plausible and attached to a moment.	Model inference as clue + reasoning where entries are vague.
Six-event line	Events are ordered, causal and selective.	Use strong anonymous models to distinguish detail from significance.
Gist	One sentence captures pressure and consequence.	Provide protagonist + pressure + consequence frames only where needed.
Reaction	Specific reason rather than unsupported approval/disapproval.	Turn reactions into evidence-based interpretations.

Resource decisions

Keep and use: the existing legally supplied story link/printout; the new two-page companion resource; the self-contained image-led IWB toolkit. Use only as teacher background: generic close-reading slides from the introductory PPT. Do not use in this lesson: additional comprehension-question packs, vocabulary hunts or technique worksheets. They would fracture the first encounter and duplicate later lessons.

After the lesson

1. Sort timelines into secure / missing hinge / over-detailed.
2. Select two anonymous gist sentences for Lesson 3: one precise, one that needs inference.
3. Note students whose reading stamina or pace needs a planned access route.
4. Retain the same annotation marks from Lesson 1; consistency matters more than novelty.
5. Begin Lesson 3 by converting one initial reaction into an explicit, implicit and inferred statement.

Teacher takeaway

The lesson succeeds if students experience the story as a controlled emotional journey and can reconstruct its causal spine. Detailed language analysis belongs to the next encounter, not this one.